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Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbron and Yeoval districts.
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\$2.50
Inc GST

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival

Time to book your Boot Tent

Convict causeway closed for months - P 2

Golf Club Centenary Sunday - P 4, 17, & back page

Guys & Dolls, are you up for the challenge? - P 7 & 14

Another murder in Wellington

SATURDAY DAY MORNING began as another peaceful autumn day until numerous sirens broke the stillness heralding the probability of a major incident.

Gisborne Street residents along the eastern quarter were alerted when police vehicle arrived at a neighbour’s house where a crime scene was soon established.

They were responding to reports of a concern for welfare.

Detectives under Strike Force Fedonia commenced an investigation into the circumstances surrounding the incident, with the assistance of the State Crime Commands Homicide Squad.

At about 8.10am on March 14 police and emergency services found the body of a man, aged 76 and a 74-year-old woman seriously injured inside the home.

The woman was treated by NSW Ambulance paramedics before being airlifted to hospital, where she remains in a critical condition.

Following an extensive search of the area, about 10.15am the same morning, a 30-year-old man was arrested inside a fast-food restaurant on Arthur Street, before being taken to Wellington Police Station where he was charged with two domestic violence- related offences including murder and cause grievous bodily harm to person with intent.

He was refused bail to appear before Bail Division Court 4 the next day (Sunday) when refuse bail was continued for another hearing in the future.

Investigations under Strike Force Fedonia continue.

Anyone with information about this incident is urged to contact Crime Stoppers by calling 1800 333 000 or visiting the website.



Stuart Town Advancement Association Inc.

STUART TOWN'S MAN FROM IRONBARK FESTIVAL

Saturday 4th April 2026 (Easter Saturday)

\$2 ENTRY PER PERSON
Children 5 and Under FREE
From 9am

3 Time Aust. Bush Poet Champion Gregory North

FREE Jumping Castle & Slide - Street Parade
Beard Competition - FREE Bucking Bull - Reptile Show
Sheep Dog Trials - FREE Children's Train - Meet the Dinosaurs
Car & Bike Show - FREE Face Painting - Food Stalls
Art Exhibition - Market Stalls - Yabby Races
FREE Merry-Go-Round - Easter Egg Hunt
Live Music with Mick, Tracie & Deb

New Council General Manager

ANDREW WILSMORE will be Council's new General Manager following a decision at the Extraordinary Council Meeting last Friday evening.

Andrew has spent the last three years as the CEO of Alice Springs Town Council.

Prior to that he had a long career in the corporate world with National Farmers Federation, Woolworth, Dan Murphys and the Endeavour Group.

Mr Wilsmore brings strong credentials and experience in business strategy development and execution, organisational and team cultural change abilities, talent development, operational management, financial and fiduciary skills.

Canberra Meetings

Last week I travelled to Parliament House, Canberra to chair the Regional Capital Australia Group of Councils meeting with a wide variety of Ministers.

The main points we emphasised were the need for:

* Grant money to Councils for enabling infrastructure to help open up more

housing development so that ratepayers aren't left out of pocket.

* The importance of regional airports such as Bodangora Airstrip and Dubbo City Regional Airport to local and the wider communities. 60% of the 200 Council owned airports run at a loss.

A more sustainable funding model is needed from the Commonwealth to ensure that our airports remain viable for the essential services of health, education, business and passenger travel.

* Water infrastructure needs a huge investment as councils simply don't have the cash for the upgrades required to provide drinking water as aging plants reach the end of their useful life.

Review of Rates Structure 2026/2027

At the Standing Committee Meetings, Councillors noted that the 2026/2027 rate structure incorporate a General Income Variation increase (the rate pegging limit) of 3.0% being the maximum permitted for the 2026/2027 rating year as determined by IPART. Councillors also recommended the

following:

* That the rates structure be included in the Revenue Policy as part of the 2026/2027 Operational Plan include newly defined boundaries for the Business Wellington Road rating sub-category and the Residential Geurie rating sub-category.

* That the rates structure be included in the Revenue Policy as part of the 2026/2027 Operational Plan include a new rating sub-category Residential Daisy Hill.

* That the reduction in rate yield resulting from the re-categorisation of properties from Business Wellington Road to Business Ordinary be recovered from the Business Ordinary rating category.

Youth Week Activities in Wellington

Come down to Kennard Park on Friday 17 April from 11am – 3pm and enjoy a great range of free activities for young people including games and inflatable obstacle course.

Free School Holiday Activities in

Wellington

Keep the kids entertained these autumn school holidays with some great free sessions at the Wellington Library.

3D pen pencil holder - Create your own pencil holder using our new 3D pens Tuesday 7 April | 10:30 am - 12 pm | Ages 8 - 14 | Bookings required.

Fidget photo cube - Create a fun fidget cube with your own photos Tuesday 14 April | 10:30 am - 12 pm | Ages 5 - 13 | Bookings required.

also Thursday 16 April | 10:30 am - 12 pm | Ages 5 - 13 | Bookings required.

Illustration begins with a scribble - Join illustrator Dub Leffler as he shares the importance of scribbling, and the magic of illustration.

Friday 17 April | 10:30 am - 11:30 am | Ages 5 - 13 | Bookings required.

For more information visit www.mrl.nsw.gov.au or contact Wellington Library on 6840 1780.

Josh Black

“We will not risk lives”: Extra rail and transport services to be rolled out as Great Western Highway closure to remain in place for at least three months - *Jenny Aitchison, minister for Roads and Transport*

EXTRA RAIL, coach and bus services to support Blue Mountains and Central West communities are being initiated by the state government.

This action has begun since specialist engineers advised the closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass which will remain in place for at least three months, according to minister for roads and transport Jenny Aitchison.

This action follows a major geotechnical failure at Mitchell's Causeway which has made the road unsafe.

The Government is being upfront with the community: this is a serious situation, it will take time, and there will be no shortcuts on safety.

The Government recognises this closure is causing real disruption for Blue Mountains and Central West communities, local businesses, freight operators and families on both sides of the pass.

People deserve clear advice they can plan around

That is why the Government is announcing that this will be a lengthy closure, while also putting additional transport support in place to help communities manage the disruption.

Transport for NSW has advised that at least two weeks of specialist geotechnical testing and 3D imaging must be carried out with no passing traffic to understand the full extent of the damage.

Even under the most optimistic scenario, any remediation required to make the road safe for vehicles would take at least a further two months.

To support communities during the closure, Transport for NSW will:

* Sydney Trains has committed to providing additional services between Bathurst and Mount Victoria, with timetable details being worked through
* provide two fully accessible coaches to run 12 daily NSW TrainLink services between Bathurst and Katoomba – six in each direction. These free turn-up-and-go services will stop at Katoomba, Mount Victoria, Lithgow and Bathurst stations

* Run amended school and regular route bus services operated by Lithgow Buslines to help reduce journey times for students on routes affected by the highway closure

* Boost resilience of road along Bells Line of Road and Darling Causeway to reduce traffic impacts and preserve road quality.

The 194-year-old Mitchell's Causeway, also known as the Convict Bridge, has been closed in both directions since Sunday, March 8, after proactive monitoring by Transport for NSW detected significant cracking and movement in the substructure.

Around 90 staff, including specialist engineers, maintenance workers and operational crews, have been working around the clock.

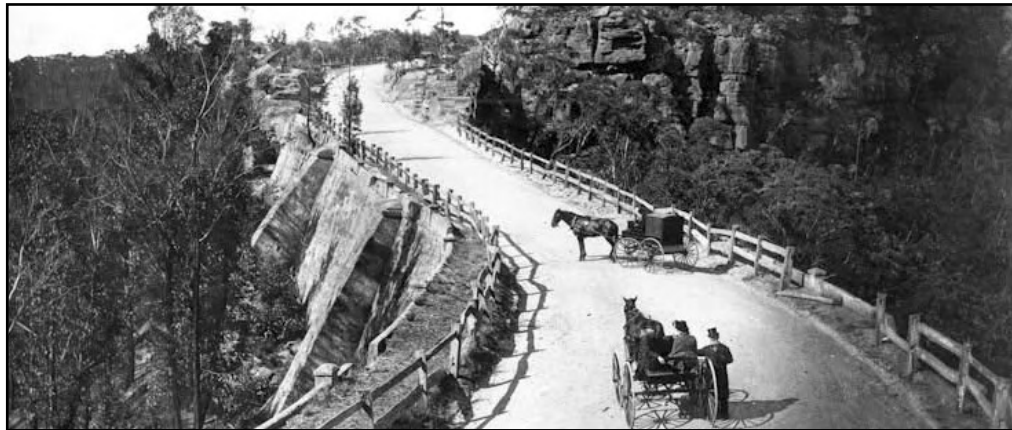
The Government is receiving regular briefings from Transport for NSW, supported by third-party engineering, geology and heritage experts on site.

An incident management team has been established

to coordinate with other government agencies, local councils, freight operators, the National Heavy Vehicle Regulator and other affected stakeholders.

Alternative route

The alternate route via Darling Causeway to Bells Line of Road is typically adding up to 25 minutes to a crossing of the Blue Mountains, but motorists should expect heavier traffic and delays, particularly during peak periods and on weekends.



Traffic control points remain staffed across the Mountains and may temporarily stop general traffic to allow critical movements by emergency vehicles and essential health staff.

Bells Line of Road will continue to carry most detoured traffic from the Great Western Highway. Motorists are urged to consider alternative long-distance routes, including the Hume Highway or Golden Highway, or



Roads minister, mayor, local members and engineers walk to talk.

alternate modes of transport where suitable.

Minister Aitchison has been on site at Mount Victoria for briefings from Transport experts and to hear from the local community and those impacted.

The Minister is working closely with her Cabinet colleagues to support the response.

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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General manager council appointed announced

BRINGING A wide career in the corporate world with National Farmers Federation, Woolworth, Dan Murphys and the Endeavour Group, Andrew Wilshire has been appointed General Manager of Dubbo Regional Council (DRC), following a decision of Council last Friday evening.

In his most recent role as Chief Executive Officer at Alice Springs Town Council, Mr Wilshire said he had the opportunity to lead both a cultural and organisational effectiveness journey with his leadership grounded in accountability, collaboration and a ‘ratepayer first’ mindset. “I’m really excited to be appointed to the role of General Manager for Dubbo Regional Council, which gives me the opportunity to contribute to the Dubbo region’s vision and deliver meaningful outcomes for the communities,” Mr Wilshire said.

“The Dubbo Region is clearly a dynamic and exciting place right now with so many great projects and a lot of development underway. “I am eager to keep these projects moving forward while also making sure Council continues to provide high quality services for all residents in our Local Government Area.”

Mayor Josh Black said council was pleased to have Mr Wilshire on board. “After a rigorous process, Councillors were pleased to be able to appoint Andrew to the role at our Extraordinary Meeting on Friday evening,” he said.

“We are all looking forward to working alongside Andrew as our Council continues to achieve great things for the communities across our region and our residents who live in our cities, towns and villages.”

In stepping into the role as general manager Mr Wilshire brings strong credentials and experience in business strategy development and execution, organisational and team cultural change abilities, talent development, operational management, financial and fiduciary skills.

Mr Wilshire grew up in Country NSW and has many memories of playing country and school cricket carnivals in Dubbo.

He said this role would bring him closer to family.

“I also have had reasons to come to Dubbo on several occasions, and I came to appreciate how significant the town is as a regional centre, connector for rural business and operating as both



a destination and gateway for tourists,” Mr Wilshire said.

In announcing the new general manager, the mayor also praised the work of Luke Ryan, who has served in the role as interim general manager since December 2025.

“Luke has done a fantastic job in the role, serving our community to an exceptionally high standard over the past six months,” Cllr Black said.

Mr Ryan will return to his substantive role as council’s director infrastructure.

Mr Wilshire will start his duties on May 25.

Andrew Wilshire will be returning to country NSW when he takes up the position of Dubbo Regional Council General manager in May. Pictured at left he is congratulated by mayor Josh Black after announcing the appointment this week.



One Stop Automotive Shop

We Service New Cars and you get to keep the Warranty

We offer Pink/Green/Blue slips
Servicing new and old vehicles

Daniel Blackhall: 02 6845 4062 | 0439 589 860
Email: onestopautomotiveshop@hotmail.com
36A Gisborne Street, Wellington

New Workshop:

Why Die?

Sunday 29th March
10am to 2pm

All welcome! Please call 6845 4661



Wellington Buddhist Centre
Tharpa Choeling Australia

Doors open at revamped Bellhaven for Uungula Wind Farm workers

Vacant for eight years, Bellhaven has a new lease on life

EIGHT YEARS after the doors were closed, the former Bellhaven aged care facility overlooking Wellington township has been transformed into temporary accommodation for employees on Squadron Energy’s Uungula Wind Farm east of town, with the first workers moving in this week.

Bellhaven, unoccupied since 2018, has undergone extensive refurbishment by local First Nations businesses and will now provide housing for workers flying in to support construction of the wind farm.

Squadron Energy leased the 32-room facility last year following a meticulous assessment and selection process for housing options in conjunction with Dubbo Regional Council.

Squadron’s regional economic development manager Bart Sykes said repurposing the site ensured workers now had a dedicated place to stay. “Opening Bellhaven provides a permanent home for our workforce flying in while freeing up rentals and tourist accommodation for the community,” he said. This facility has gone through extensive refurbishment, with this monumental task taken up by our committed contrac-

tors who are all locals from the area. “This upgraded facility is ideal for our workers to get to and from the wind farm and supports the project. It can also be used for housing long after Uungula Wind Farm is built.”

Refurbishment works began around June last year and were completed in February.

Squadron Energy selected First Nations contractors to turn the facility into a modern, fit-for-purpose workers accommodation, which provided opportunities for local businesses.

Workers from Squadron Energy, and the company’s recruiters Aurora Energy Services and ESS, will stay at Bellhaven while the wind farm is being constructed.

Squadron Energy has leased the facility until at least 2030, with an option to extend.

Once construction of Uungula Wind Farm has been completed, Bellhaven will be available to turn into social and affordable housing or a skilled workforce training centre.

Uungula Wind Farm will feature 69 turbines and generate enough electricity to power 220,000 homes, with the project creating 250 jobs during construction.

The price of a ‘Leader’ is just half the price of a coffee



keirle's pharmacy

EXCITING NEWS

Giftware Back In Store Soon



31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059

email:keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook



Hidden Treasures Honour Roll 2026

Nominations now open

Learn more at: <https://www.nsw.gov.au/departments-and-agencies/women-nsw/rural-womens-network/hidden-treasures-honour-roll>

Dugald Saunders

MEMBER FOR THE DUBBO ELECTORATE

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Authorised by Dugald Saunders MP, 1/18 Talbragar Street Dubbo NSW 2830. Funded using Parliamentary entitlements.

100th Wellington Golf Club 100th Centenary celebrations 2026



Soldiers - Golf Club director Barry Jeffery cuts centenary cake with a former captain, Elton Keeffe during the centenary dinner last Sunday.



Sam and Tom Coon's team – Brandon, Sam, Josh and Tom.



Council workers team – Scott, Broch, Mackenzie and Nic.



Kathy Martin and John Gersbach representing club members also cut the centenary cake in celebration.



Mrs Brown's Boys team - Scott, Tim, Steve and Jack.





Intersection upgrade improves safety for motorists while progresses Uungula Wind Farm

ROADWORKS HAVE been completed on the Goolma and Twelve Mile Road intersection upgrade east of Wellington, creating a widened road for communities in the Central West region.

Squadron Energy upgraded the intersection as part of work for its Uungula Wind Farm.

The intersection was revamped to give more space for vehicles travelling through and to provide better road conditions and drainage.

Squadron Energy executive general manager development and delivery, Tony Clark, said the upgrade was a turning point for motorists in the area.

“The completion of the Goolma and Twelve Mile Road intersection highlights a major milestone in our efforts to develop markedly improved roads that benefit the local community and those travelling through the region,” he said.

“With the completion of the upgrade to Twelve Mile Road and now the intersection, we are creating safer roads that will reduce the likelihood of accidents and provide better conditions for all road users.

“The widening of the road is also a milestone for Uungula Wind Farm, as we can now begin to safely deliver components to site.”

Mr Clark said the new road is a permanent feature that will last beyond the construction of the wind farm.

“The upgrade to the intersection will create a lasting impact for the region long after our projects are up

and running,” he said.

“This safer, more improved section of road leaves the community and visitors to the Central West better off in the long term.”

Council’s acting general manager Luke Ryan said the improved intersection was a positive outcome for the region.

“The upgraded Goolma Road intersection is a real win for residents, local businesses, and visitors passing through,” he said.

“The improved section will greatly improve safety for all motorists at this location.

“Thanks to Squadron Energy for their work on this project and providing a greatly improved piece of infrastructure to our local community”.

Squadron Energy will start delivering components to Uungula Wind Farm in the coming months, subject to final approvals.

Uungula Wind Farm will feature 69 turbines and generate enough electricity to power 220,000 homes, with the project creating 250 jobs during construction.

There is still some concern from Twelve Mile Road residents that windfarm transport to and from the Uungula site will interfere with local livestock producers carting stock to and from their properties, particularly for Dubbo livestock sales each week, as previous agreements have been lost with new company members and transport companies taking over management.



Life and rhymes of Banjo Paterson coming to Wellington

KNOWING THE close connection to the local Barton family, WATS President, Julie Hancock, could not be happier to help bring the Life and Rhymes of Banjo Paterson to Wellington.

Born in Boree, near Cudal, Banjo was a first cousin to Dr Nat Barton, a much-loved Wellington figure for most of the 20th Century.

He was a regular visitor to the Barton home, ‘Nanima’, and many stories of his stays there have filtered down through the generations of Wellington Bartons.

Banjo Paterson was, of course, famous for the creation of bush ballads Waltzing Matilda and The Man from Snowy River and on the 19th September, 1901 presented a lecture on the Boer War in Wellington.

With the 125th anniversary of this historic tour, Gregory North, three-times Australian champion bush poet, will give a tribute to Banjo Paterson’s visit when he performs his 90-minute show at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club on Sunday, April 19 at 2pm.

The show will be a mix of stories, songs and poetry that will bring Paterson’s strong connection to the bush and its characters to life.

As North says, “Banjo’s humour still entertains and reminds us of what it is to be Australian. I really enjoy performing poetry and bringing the characters in the poems to life”.

He said poetry was meant to be heard and hopes his use of voices and actions enhance Banjo’s words and bring back memories for audience members.

Throughout his touring, Gregory North has seen that the humour and recognition of fair-dinkum Australians in Banjo’s verse seems to be appreciated by all Australians regardless of where they live.

“I think Australia is so lucky to have that unique heritage of verse that helped us become the nation we are today”.



Gregory North as Banjo Paterson will have the audience swooning in their seats with pros and verse in rhyme.

The ‘Life & Rhymes of Banjo Paterson’ show gives a thorough insight into the fascinating life of a great Australian whose influence is still felt today.

“There are some wonderful images to accompany the show and I look forward to bringing his poems to life on the stage”.

This will be nostalgic for anyone who has heard or read a Banjo Paterson poem.

“There’s a wide variety of his poetry presented in the show which gives an idea of the diversity of his subjects and moods and the adventures he experienced during his rich

life,” Mr North said.

“I hope that younger people will come along to see what the fuss is about too and be turned on to the fun of Banjo’s words”.

The Life & Rhymes of Banjo Paterson will be performed at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club at 2pm on Sunday, April 19.

Tickets are \$30 for Adults and \$20 for Children under 16.

Tickets can be purchased online at 123tix.com.au or at the DOOR (if not sold-out prior).

For group tickets or any further information contact Julie Hancock on 0412 909 490.

Life & Rhymes of Banjo Paterson

Hear your favourite poems and all about his amazing life on the 125th anniversary of Banjo's visit

2 pm Sunday 19 April 2026
Wellington Memorial Soldiers Club

75 Arthur Street, Wellington
Tickets \$30, children \$20 at www.123tix.com.au/events/52054 or at the door

with three-times Australian champion bush poet

Gregory North

Banjo Paterson presented a lecture on the Boer War in Wellington on 19 April 1901

NSW loses out again Volunteer grants available in GST carve-up

NEW SOUTH WALES will receive its lowest GST relativity share since the tax was introduced, leaving Australia’s largest state with \$1.4 billion less GST revenue in 2026-27 than Victoria, despite having 1.5 million more people.

Acting Treasurer Courtney Houssos said the complex and opaque calculations used by the Commonwealth Grants Commission once again highlight a broken and unfair system in urgent need of reform.

“As cost-of-living pressures continue to rise for families, essential workers and young people, the State Government is again calling on the Commonwealth Grants Commission to reform its GST distribution formula, which has left Australia’s largest state sending nearly one in every five dollars of the GST we have paid across the border to other states,” she said.

In the latest determination, NSW’s share of the GST pool has fallen to 82.0 cents in the dollar, down from 86.0 cents last year, and 92.4 cents in 2024.

This means that for every dollar that NSW residents hand over in GST, the State gets back 82 cents.

The determination leaves NSW with its lowest share since the GST was introduced in 2000.

“Despite this, NSW continues to maintain its strong credit ratings and is currently rated AAA by Moody’s and Fitch Ratings, and AA+ by S&P Global, after inheriting record state debt of \$188 billion from the former Liberal-National government,” Ms Houssos said.

Since coming to office, this Government has focused on repairing the state’s finances and being disciplined in its spending.

“Annual expenses growth was 2.8

per cent in the first two years of this Government, the lowest rate for any Australian government, and below inflation.

“This is compared to expense growth averaging over 6pc in NSW between 2011 and 2023. Gross debt is projected to be the second lowest in the country, after being forecast to reach over \$188 billion in 2026 by the former government.”

Ms Houssos said the Government will continue to invest in the infrastructure and essential services required to support the state’s families, workers and young people.

“As part of the current Productivity Commission inquiry, the Government will also continue to advocate for fairer reforms to the Commonwealth Grants Commission’s GST distribution system.

“This includes that GST distribution would be fairer on a per capita basis, with the Commonwealth stepping in to support horizontal fiscal equalization for the smaller states.

This state Government has introduced a suite of reforms to cut red tape, provide cost-of-living relief for families and attract major capital investment to NSW including:

- * Landmark reforms to the state’s planning legislation.
- * Reforming workers compensation to reduce premiums for businesses.
- * Introducing a toll-cap and lifting the Liberal-National Government’s unfair freeze on wages.
- * The establishment of the Investment Delivery Authority.

“This is all part of the Minns Government’s plan to build a better NSW with more homes, jobs and services, so people have somewhere to live and work in the communities they choose.”

THE DEPARTMENT of Social Services is offering Volunteer Grants to support the amazing work of community organisations that rely on volunteers.

Eligible notforprofit organisations can apply for \$1000 to \$5000 to help purchase communication or insurance items, and/or items that directly support volunteer cohorts and volunteer-run activities, as outlined in the Grant Opportunity Guidelines.

The 2025–26 Volunteer Grants are now open for expressions of interest.

Organisations are encouraged to read the Grant Opportunity Guidelines and contact my Office for details on how to submit an expression of interest.

Expressions of Interest must be returned to my office by 1st April 2026.

Nominated organisations will then be invited by DSS to submit a full application in May 2026.

For more info, guidelines, or help with applying, call my Office on (02) 6331 0524 or email:

andrew.gee.mp@aph.gov.au

Tertiary access payment

The Tertiary Access Payment (TAP) is a one-off payment of up to \$5000.

It’s to help eligible students with the cost of moving to study.

This is for study after you’ve finished year 12 or equivalent.

To get the payment you must move from a regional or remote area for tertiary study.

You can check if your family home is in a regional or remote area using the Student Regional Area Search.

You can still claim TAP if you get ABSTUDY, Youth Allowance or Relocation Scholarship in your first year of study.

www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/ tertiary-access-payment

Supporting farmer facing hardship

The Federal Government has introduced a new Drought Hardship Loan designed to help with short-term operating costs as farmers face longer-term droughts.

The loan will enable farmers who have been affected by drought for at least 24 months and expect to be impacted for another season, to borrow up to \$250,000.

The loan duration will be five years, with interest incurred, but repayments fully deferred for the first two years.

To extend relief to existing RIC loan customers, interest rates on existing RIC loans will be held at 5.18 per cent for another six months from 1 February, 2026.

The new Drought Hardship Loan is delivered through the Regional Investment Corporation and you can register your interest at



<https://www.ric.gov.au/new-loans>

Strengthening rural communities – small and vital

Foundation for Rural Regional Renewal

The Strengthening Rural Communities (SRC) Small & Vital stream gives small remote, rural and regional communities across Australia the opportunity to access funds for a broad range of initiatives that directly and clearly benefit local communities.

Small grants up to \$10,000 are available for a broad range of grassroots, community-led initiatives that directly and clearly benefit local communities with a preference for smaller communities (populations less than 15,000).

The timeframe to deliver these projects is up to 12 months.

Program Guidelines:

<https://frrr.org.au/funding/src-small-vital/#program-guidelines>

Round 28 Closes: 24 March, 2026 at 5pm

Churchill Fellowship now open

Each year, Australians from every sector, industry and community are invited to take a bold step — to explore a question, challenge a system, investigate global best practice, and bring practical solutions home.

Churchill Fellowships are a unique chance to travel overseas for four to eight weeks, investigate global best practice, and apply your new knowledge and skills in your community when you return.

Key facts: * Churchill Fellowships are a chance to travel and study best practice in an industry/field of interest and then apply the new knowledge or skills for the benefit of the community on return to Australia.* Australian citizens and permanent residents over the age of 18 years, from any industry, background or location are eligible to apply. (No academic qualification is necessary). Applications close Thursday 5pm, 30 April 2026.

You can find more information at:

<https://www.churchilltrust.com.au/application-round-resources/>



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

I AM declaring it now: electric vehicles are about to have their Toyota Corolla moment.

That might sound like a strange comparison. The Corolla is hardly the kind of car that makes people swoon.

It’s practical, reliable and about as flashy as a pair of sensible shoes. But sometimes the most important technologies arrive quietly, and the real story only becomes clear when we look back.

So let’s look back to the early 1970s.

The American car market was dominated by massive sedans with engines as large as 7.4 litres. Petrol was cheap, and efficiency was barely a consideration.

Into that landscape arrived a small Japanese import: the Toyota Corolla.

It looked tiny. It had a small engine, sipped fuel rather than guzzling it, and came with a price tag that made it attractive to families watching their budgets.

It was one of several Japanese cars quietly entering the market at the time, alongside brands like Datsun (now Nissan), Honda, Mazda and Subaru.

At first, they were curiosities.

Then history intervened.

In 1973 the world was hit by the oil crisis. Following conflict in the Middle East, several major oil-producing nations restricted exports, particularly to countries supporting Israel, which included the US. Global supply suddenly tightened and oil prices surged.

In just a few months the price of crude jumped from US\$3 a barrel to nearly US\$12.

Petrol stations across the United States saw long queues. Some areas introduced rationing.

For the first time in decades, American drivers began asking a simple question: do I really need a giant car with a giant engine?

Small, efficient cars suddenly looked very appealing.

In 1973, Japanese vehicles held only 6.5 per cent of the market.

But that share began climbing quickly.

Petrol prices eventually eased as the crisis passed, and for a moment it seemed like the

old habits might return. But in 1979 the Iranian Revolution triggered another major disruption to oil supplies. Global oil prices surged again, rising rapidly from US\$15 a barrel to almost US\$40.

Once again, drivers reconsidered their vehicles.

This time the shift was emphatic. By 1980, Japanese car sales in the United States had climbed past 21pc of the entire market. What began as a niche import had become a mainstream choice.

That was the Corolla moment.

Not just a popular car, but a turning point in how people thought about cars.

Which brings us to today.

Electric vehicles have been steadily gaining traction for years, but the data shows something interesting: EV sales rise when petrol prices rise.

One major US study found that every one-cent increase in petrol prices lifted electric vehicle sales by half a percent.

In simple terms, a 20-cent rise in fuel prices could translate into a 10pc increase

in EV purchases.

And, with history repeating itself, we find the global oil market feeling the pressure of a conflict involving Iran.

The solution this time is not a fuel-efficient vehicle, but a vehicle that uses no petrol at all.

Electric Vehicles!

There is more variety and availability of EVs, battery technology and driving range have advanced, and charging networks are already in place.

History tells us that big technological shifts rarely happen simply because a new idea

exists. They happen when that new idea arrives at the exact moment the old way becomes inconvenient or expensive.

Pushed as the oil shocks of the seventies pushed millions of drivers toward small Japanese cars, today’s volatile fuel prices will push drivers towards EVs.

History will show that 2026 was the year that EVs had their Toyota Corolla moment.

Lions show-off new catering van

WELLINGTON LIONS on Safari Month barbecue attracted many visitors, all enjoying a sausage sanga at the club’s preloved book shop last Saturday.

While there, Councillor Lucas Butler Checked out the new catering van with president John Pringle and Lion Ken Vodden.

With the new catering van Lions will be back at Stuart Town’s Man from Ironbark Festival on Saturday, April 4, so call in and say good-day to the local Lions.

There is new stock coming into the book shop every week and Lions thank everyone who came and bought things, also to the people who donated lots of books on Saturday.

As we have said “there is always new stock coming in!”, but it does mean the shop is still overstocked, so don’t forget the special sale is still on.

At the last meeting the District Governor from Bathurst attended and was able to induct two new members, it is good to have new people with new ideas.

Next meeting is Monday, March 23 for a 6pm start in the Private Room at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club. Members meet at 5.30 before the meeting for a chat, and all are welcome to go along.

Justice Health NSW welcomes 43 new graduate nurses

FORTY-THREE new graduate nurses have started at Justice Health and Forensic Mental Health Network (Justice Health NSW), providing a significant boost to health services in the state’s youth justice centres, correctional centres, and at the Forensic Hospital in Sydney.

The nurses will be stationed across both metro and regional areas including Werrington, Kariong, Malabar, Silverwater, Windsor, Wellington, Bathurst, Lithgow, Nowra, Junee, Cessnock, Shortland and Kempsey.

The nursing graduates will work as part of multi-disciplinary teams alongside experienced clinicians, who will support them to develop the skills and knowledge to care for patients with complex and diverse health needs.

Chief Executive Wendy Hoey said the new graduates will support patients to make healthier and more informed choices.

“I want to extend my sincere gratitude to each of the 43 new graduate nurses for choosing an exceptionally rewarding career,” Ms Hoey said.

“Much of the work delivered by Justice Health NSW occurs out of public view, but the impact of these clinical staff will help transform the lives of our patients.”

The nursing graduates joined Justice Health NSW through the GradStart program, which supports them to build experience and consolidate their skills across mental health, primary care, drug and alcohol, and public health.

Kaitlin Barnsley, a previous GradStart participant, said the experience was incredibly rewarding and one they would recommend to others.

“As part of the GradStart program, I completed two rotations across different centres, which gave me valuable exposure to a range of clinical skills and the opportunity to work in different environments with diverse teams,” Ms Barnsley said.

“The program challenged me to step outside my comfort zone, but the rewards were far greater than I could have imagined. I was able to build confidence as a practitioner and strengthen my abilities to advocate for my patients while working closely with Corrective Services NSW and other healthcare professionals.

“Overall, the graduate year has laid a strong foundation for my development as a safe, competent and compassionate registered nurse, and I feel well prepared to continue building my skills and expanding my clinical expertise.”





Wellington & District
LEADER





Are you up for the challenge?

Wellington Boot 2026

TOOHEYS

GUYS AND DOLLS

CHALLENGE

If you’re aged 18 to 30 years you’re eligible to enter the 2026 Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge at the Wellington Boot Racing Carnival, Friday, April 10 and Sunday April 12.

Entry forms available at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club or on the club’s website.

You must attend the Calcutta 6pm Saturday night (April 11) to win a horse, and gain free entry to Sunday’s Boot Day, as guest of Wellington Race Club including lunch and drinks.

Prizes to challengers who pick 1st, 2nd, 3rd placings

See the Guys and Dolls story on Page 14.

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL

MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



RUNS ON THE BOARD FOR WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

CENTRAL WEST HIT BY CRISES OF HISTORIC PROPORTIONS

Our region is being throttled by a dual failure of infrastructure and essential fuel supply that is threatening our economy, our food security and the very fabric of our communities.

FUEL CRISIS

A major fuel crisis is unfolding before our eyes. This isn't only a matter of punishing prices; this is also a crisis of availability.

I'm hearing from farmers across our electorate who are ringing the alarm bells.

We are at the critical cusp of planting season, yet our producers cannot secure the diesel needed to sow their crops. They're ordering the diesel, and it's simply not being delivered. Local service stations are running out of fuel.

Rationing has started. Prices are skyrocketing. If our farmers cannot plant, this nation does not eat. The government must guarantee supply before this fuel crisis becomes a full-scale national food shortage.

In Parliament last week, I demanded that the government take immediate action to secure our local fuel supply.

You can see videos of my speeches on the fuel crisis on my Facebook page. **Scan the QR code.**



I am continuing to fight hard to ensure that the Federal Government takes action during this unprecedented crisis.



Image by AUSPIC, Department of Parliamentary Services

INFURIATING CHAIN-GANG GREAT WESTERN HIGHWAY

Adding to this burden is the catastrophic indefinite closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass. The impacts of this are devastating.

How is it that, in the Australia of 2026, the main access road in and out of our region is reliant on a bridge built by a convict chain gang in the 1830s? You cannot make this up.

In Lithgow, as Mayor Cassandra Coleman highlights, 11,000 extra vehicles are being

funnelled through the CBD every day, pounding local roads that Council is already owed \$7.2 million for in unpaid disaster recovery funding.

Locals are pointing to the long delays this is now causing businesses and the dangerous route along the Darling Causeway, not built for such an increase in diverted heavy vehicle traffic.

Local businesses are at breaking point watching their customer traffic vanish overnight. Sharon, the owner of a local retail shop in Hartley Valley, said that the most terrifying word in the English language right now is 'indefinite'.

Sharon is already seeing income slashed by more than half.

Everyone fears more 'forever roadworks' that we know all too well.

The impacts are region wide. Jacqui, a farm business owner from Oberon, has written to me because she is already seeing mass cancellations for the Easter period.

Western regional director for Business NSW, Vicki Seccombe, said local businesses have reached breaking point. She said the highway closure comes at a time when businesses are already under intense pressure. This disruption piles on more pressure at a time when many businesses are already operating on very thin margins.

In Parliament last week, I demanded that the Federal Government commit to funding for a genuine expressway through the Blue Mountains.

I also raised the issue of the Great Western Highway with the PM in Question Time, asking him if he would put pressure on the NSW Government, and work with it, to secure the expressway to Sydney.

Unfortunately, the PM flicked the response to the Infrastructure Minister, and a direct answer was not given.

You can see the video of my speech on the Great Western Highway closure on my Facebook page. **Scan the QR code.**



SPECTACULAR POLITICAL FAILURE

What is truly infuriating—what is stoking deep and justified anger across our electorate—is the feeling that the people of the Central West are being treated as second-class citizens.

It's a ludicrous, disgraceful indictment of all political parties and decades of neglect. Our communities make an enormous contribution to the wealth of this state and nation. Our regional economy drives this country. Yet, when it comes to infrastructure, we are treated as an afterthought.



The citizens of the Central West see gold plated tunnels being bored under Sydney at a cost of billions. They see world-class expressways stretching from the north coast to the south coast. Yet successive governments have avoided spending the money we need to build a genuine expressway to Sydney.

We've seen everything from empty National Party sod-turnings on a Bells Line of Road expressway and a failure to fully commit to the Great Western Highway to the snatching away by this government of billions in committed funding.

"They've all just been kicking the can down the road, and now that road is disintegrating beneath our feet".

The Great Western Highway is not fit for purpose, and you can't fix it with bandaid solutions. The anger in our communities is real.

Watch this three month closure drag on for years. Buckle up for more forever road works!

ACTION NEEDED NOW

I call on the government to take immediate action so that our farmers can sow their crops and our businesses can keep their doors open and our regional workforce employed.

In the upcoming budget I call on the government to commit to the funding for a genuine expressway through the mountains as an urgent national infrastructure priority project.

The people of the Central West pay our taxes and contribute more than our fair share to this country. It's time that governments and political parties of all stripes stop treating our communities as an inconvenience and start giving us the infrastructure we need and we deserve. We demand our fair share of government funding and an end to these debilitating crises.

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follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew GEE MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

5x5

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

M		R		S
	W		R	
S		L		N
	I		L	
S		Y		E

Edgeword

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

EDGG

ESDI

BOER

ASNI

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	+		×		=	11
+		×		×		
	÷		×		=	14
+		-		÷		
	+		-		=	10
=		=		=		
22		17		4		

Solutions

5SAS3
EDDIES,
BOINER,
BOGGED,
EDGEWORD

E	T	Y	T	S
S	T	L	I	T
N	O	L	A	S
E	R	A	W	A
S	T	S	M	A

5XS

	4		17		22
	=		=		=
10	=	2	-	3	+ 6
		÷		-	+
14	=	8	×	4	÷ 7
		×		×	+
11	=	1	×	5	+ 9

H1AWSSORO

	6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Compass. 11.30 Songs Of Praise. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Landline. 1.30 Gardening Australia. 2.30 The Piano. 3.40 Judi Dench: Shakespeare, My Family And Me. 4.30 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 5.00 Back Roads. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Compass. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 The Piano. 8.20 Can You Keep A Secret? 8.50 Frauds. 9.40 Blue Murder Motel. 10.25 Top End Bub. 10.50 MOVIE: Sweet Country. (2017) 12.40 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 3.20 The Yorkshire Vet. 4.20 Australia's Big Backyards. 5.20 The Aussie Property Flippers. 6.20 Escape To The Country. 7.20 The Vicar Of Dibley. 8.30 Vera. 10.30 Miss Scarlet And The Duke. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.20 Not Going Out. 3.05 A Bite To Eat. 3.35 QI. 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.35 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Louis Theroux: Shooting Joe Exotic. 9.20 The Piano. 10.10 Late Programs.

	6.00 NBC Today. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Sunday Footy Feast. 2.30 To Be Advised. 3.45 Surveillance Oz. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Sydney Weekender. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Australian Idol. 8.10 Britain's Got Talent. 9.30 The Hunters. 11.00 24 Hours In Police Custody. 12.00 A Friend Of The Family. 1.10 Travel Oz. 2.00 Home Shopping. 3.30 Million Dollar Minute. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Red's Fishing Adventures. 2.30 AFL Pre-Game Show. 3.00 Football. AFL. Pt Adel v Essendon. 6.00 Border Security: International. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 8.30 MOVIE: Kingsman: The Golden Circle. (2017) Taron Egerton. 11.25 Late Programs.
	6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.15 Dino Dex. 4.40 Gardening Australia Junior. 5.05 Fireman Sam: Pontypandy's Big Show. 5.55 Octonauts. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 The Investigators. 8.00 Badgers: Their Secret World. 8.45 Amazing Animal Friends. 9.35 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.15 Merlin. 11.00 Late Programs.

	6.00 Hello SA. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Wide World Of Sports. 11.00 NRL Sunday Footy Show. 1.00 Drive TV: Drive Car Of The Year. Return. 1.30 Fishing Australia. 2.00 David Attenborough's Dynasties II. 3.00 Rugby League. NRL. Round 3. Parramatta Eels v St George Illawarra Dragons. 6.00 9News Sunday. 7.00 Married At First Sight. 8.30 60 Minutes. 9.30 9News Late. 10.00 My Wife, My Killer And The Secret Footage. 11.00 The First 48. 11.50 A Killer Makes A Call. 12.40 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Australian Idol. 3.30 A Moveable Feast. 4.00 Jabba's Movies School Holiday Special. 4.30 Gold Coast Ocean Rescue. 5.00 Behave Yourself. 6.00 Puppy School. 6.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 News. 2.30 Aust Story. 3.00 News. 3.30 Offsiders. 4.00 Landline. 5.00 ABC News With Auslan. 5.30 ABC News Regional. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.25 Foreign Correspondent. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Insiders. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.30 Australian Story. 10.00 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 7.00 Joseph Prince. 7.30 Buy To Build. 8.00 Australia By Design: Architecture. 8.30 My Market Kitchen. 9.00 Freshly Picked. 9.30 Well Traveller. 10.00 Farm To Fork. 10.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 1.00 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 2.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 10 News+. 7.00 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 8.30 NCIS: Sydney. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 NCIS: Origins. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Tough Tested. 9.00 Reel Action. 9.30 Navigating The World. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 Top Gear Australia. 1.00 JAG. 4.00 What's Up Down Under. 4.30 JAG. 7.30 MOVIE: War Of The Worlds. (2005) Tom Cruise, Dakota Fanning. 9.50 Matlock. 10.45 Bull. 11.45 JAG. 12.45 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 AFL Sunday Footy Show. 12.00 Getaway. 12.30 MOVIE: Derby Day. (1952) 2.15 MOVIE: Orders To Kill. (1958) 4.30 Traffic Cops. 5.30 Midsomer Murders. 7.30 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 8.40 Paramedics. 9.40 Emergency. 10.40 Major Crimes. 11.40 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 PBS News Compass Points. 12.30 WorldWatch. 1.00 Cycling. Provelo Super League. Q Tour. Queen's Stage Mount Mee. 5.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 5.30 Berlin: Stories Of The City. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 The Race For Ancient Egypt In Colour. 9.25 Leonardo Da Vinci. 10.25 Lost Treasures Of Egypt. 11.20 History Of The Sitcom. 2.30 The Sculpture. 3.55 Food, Sail, Love. 4.30 Bamay. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.15 Euronews. 5.30 PBS News Horizons.
	6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 9.30 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 2.30 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Ridiculousness. 12.00 Home Shopping.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 4.00 Fashionista. 4.15 WorldWatch. 5.15 PBS News Compass Points. 5.45 Smoke And Steel: Secrets Of The Modern World. 6.40 The Architecture The Railways Built. 7.35 Abandoned Engineering. 8.30 MOVIE: Conan The Barbarian. (1982) 10.55 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 Back Roads. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Landline. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 2.55 Fake Or Fortune? 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Australian Story. 8.30 Four Corners. 9.15 Media Watch. 9.35 Planet America. 10.05 Foreign Correspondent. 10.40 ABC Late News. 10.55 The Business. 11.10 The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. 11.40 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 The Zoo. 2.00 Weekender. 2.30 Auction Squad. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Doc Martin. 8.30 A Touch Of Frost. 10.50 Ambulance: Code Red. 11.50 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.15 ER. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 The Outlaws. New. 9.30 Elementary. 10.15 Late Programs.

	6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Blankety Blank. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Australian Idol. 8.40 9-11. 9.40 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 10.40 The Agenda Setters. 11.40 Autopsy USA. 12.40 Conviction. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Motor Racing. Night Thunder. USA Speedweek. Final. Replay. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Resto. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 8.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 9.30 Outback Opal Hunters. 10.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.00 Play School. 3.40 Thomas And Friends. 4.15 Andy's Safari Adventures. 5.20 Millie Magnificent. 6.05 PJ Masks. 7.05 Batwheels. Return. 7.35 Ninjago. 8.00 Deadly 60. 8.35 Gladiators UK. 9.35 Kids BBQ Championship. 10.15 Kids Baking Championship. 11.00 Late Programs.

	6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.30 Journey To Japan. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Married At First Sight. 9.00 100% Footy. 10.00 9News Late. 10.30 Outback Opal Hunters. 11.30 Sight Unseen. 12.30 Footy Classified. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Code Black. 3.00 Australian Idol. 4.10 New Idea Test Kitchen. 4.30 The Connors. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order. 8.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Planet America. 11.00 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 7.30 GCBC. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 12.00 GCBC. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 8.45 Gogglebox Australia. 9.45 10's Late News. 10.45 10 News+. 11.20 Stephen Colbert. 12.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 1.00 Shakespeare And Hathaway. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: Some Will, Some Won't. (1970) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 To Be Advised. 10.40 Coma. 11.40 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.10 WorldWatch. 1.00 PBS News Compass Points. 1.30 WorldWatch. 2.05 Lost Cities Of The Bible. 3.05 Going Places. 3.35 The Cook Up. 4.05 The Real Spies Among Friends. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Inside The Tower Of London. 8.30 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 9.25 Never Mind The Buzzcocks. 10.05 SBS World News Late. 10.35 Other People's Money. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.10 Over The Black Dot. 2.40 Stories From The Cities. 3.10 WorldWatch. 4.05 PBS News Compass Points. 4.35 WorldWatch. 5.05 Alone Denmark. 6.15 Curse Of Oak Island. 7.05 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats. 8.30 Holy Marvels. 9.20 Greatest Escapes. 10.10 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Death In Paradise. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 2.55 Fake Or Fortune? 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Foreign Correspondent. 8.30 The Matter Of Facts. New. 9.20 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 9.50 Compass. 10.20 If You're Listening. 10.45 ABC Late News. 11.00 The Business. 11.20 Four Corners. 12.05 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 The Zoo. 2.00 Creek To Coast. 2.30 Escape To The Country. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.30 Judge John Deed. 10.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Small Town Scandal. 8.55 Can You Keep A Secret? 9.25 Elementary. 10.05 Late Programs.

	6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Blankety Blank. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Australian Idol. 8.40 Doc. 9.40 Ambulance: Code Red. 10.40 The Agenda Setters. 11.40 St. Denis Medical. 12.10 Dirty John. 1.10 Travel Oz. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Pawn Stars. 1.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 2.30 Outback Opal Hunters. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Outback Truckers. 8.30 Cape Carnage: Killer Catch. 9.30 Outback Truckers. 10.30 Railroad Australia. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.40 Thomas And Friends. 4.15 Andy's Safari Adventures. 5.20 Millie Magnificent. 6.05 PJ Masks. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago. 8.00 Deadly 60. 8.35 Deadly 60. 9.00 The Slow Mo Guys' Big Adventures. 9.25 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 9.50 BattleBots. 10.35 Late Programs.

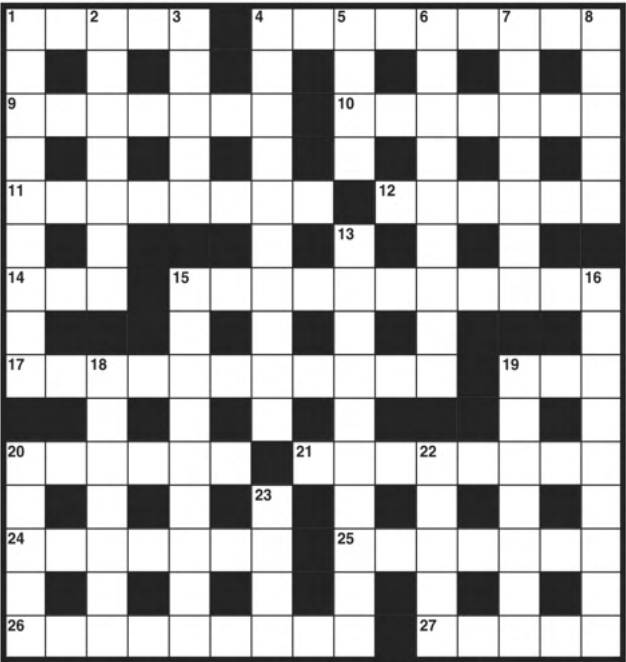
	6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.30 Getaway. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Married At First Sight. 9.00 The Hunting Wives. 10.00 9News Late. 10.30 The Killer Interview With Piers Morgan. 11.30 Next Stop. 12.00 Tipping Point. 1.00 Destination WA. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Our State On A Plate. 3.00 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Code Black. 3.00 Australian Idol. 4.10 New Idea Test Kitchen. 4.30 The Connors. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 CSI: New York. 8.30 CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. 9.30 CSI: Miami. 10.30 CSI: New York. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.15 Four Corners. 11.00 Late Programs.

	6.00 Ent. Tonight. 6.30 Bold. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 GCBC. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 11.45 My Market Kitchen. 12.00 GCBC. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 9.00 NCIS. 10.00 10's Late News. 11.00 10 News+. 11.30 Late Programs.
	6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 8.30 Fire Country. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Pointless. 11.30 My Favorite Martian. 12.00 Death In Paradise. 1.00 To Be Advised. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: Spring And Port Wine. (1970) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 New Tricks. 8.40 Agatha Christie's Marple. 10.40 Harry Wild. 11.40 Late Programs.

	6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.05 Lost Cities Of The Bible. 3.00 Trail Towns. 3.40 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.10 Secrets Of The Tower Of London. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Great Continental Railway Journeys. 8.30 Insight. 9.30 Dateline. 10.00 Rock Legends. 10.30 SBS World News Late. 11.00 Exit. 11.55 Wolf. 2.10 Charles I: To Kill A King. 3.15 Food, Sail, Love. 4.20 Bamay. 5.00 Late Programs.
	6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier.

CROSSWORD

No. 168



ACROSS

- 1 Conspiracy (5)
4 Falls; gives way (9)
9 Female name (7)
10 Foozle (7)
11 Expert (8)
12 Specify (6)

- 14 Insect (3)
15 Insect before butterfly (11)
17 Technology (11)
19 Jerk (3)
20 Fuel oil (6)
21 Halfhearted (8)

- 24 Someone who has stopped working for a living (7)
25 Truancy (7)
26 Learning; erudition (9)
27 Give way; surrender (5)

DOWN

- 1 Fellow student (9)
2 Capital of Northern Ireland (7)
3 Looped rope (5)
4 Link (10)
5 Citrus fruit (4)
6 Hired killers (9)
7 Having three dimensions (7)
8 Polish (5)
13 Form words (10)
15 Principal church of a diocese (9)
16 Endorse (9)
18 Modern music genre (7)
19 Neophyte (7)
20 Male name (5)
22 Theme (5)
23 Honey drink (4)

SOLUTION

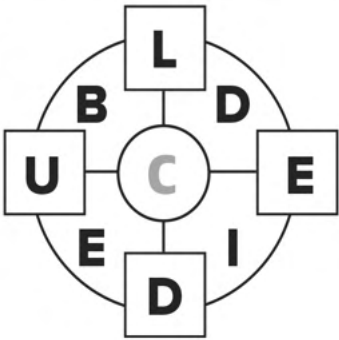


9-LETTER

No. 168

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
11 words: Good
17 words: Very good
23 words: Excellent

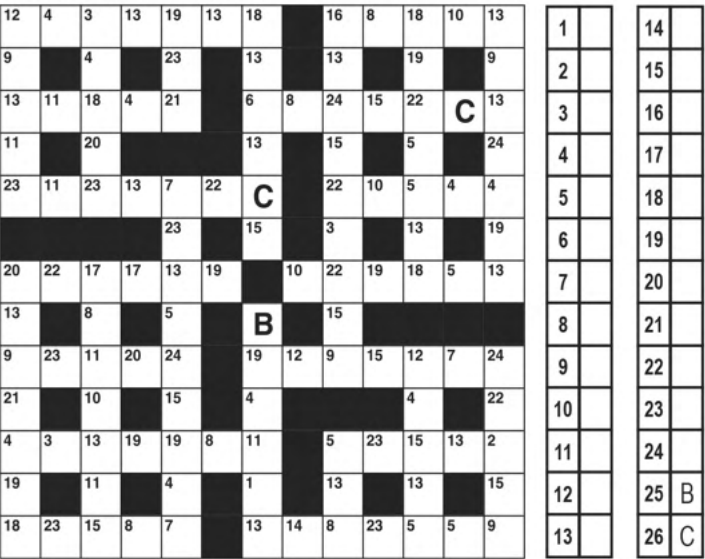


lucid, lude,
educable, iced, lice,
diced, educe, educed,
deuce, denuce, dice,
deduce, DEDUCIBLE,
cuddle, decibel, decide,
clued, cube, cubed,
cede, ceded, club, clue,

CODEWORD

No. 118

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

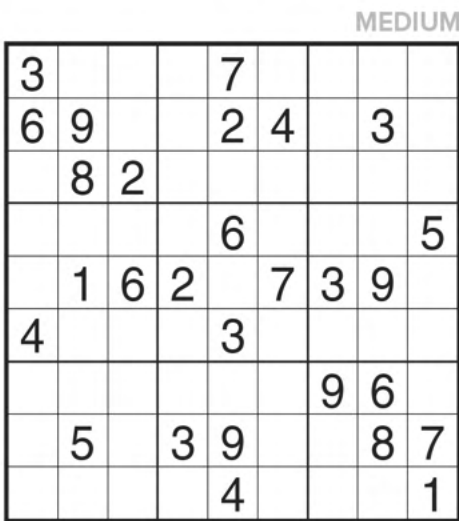
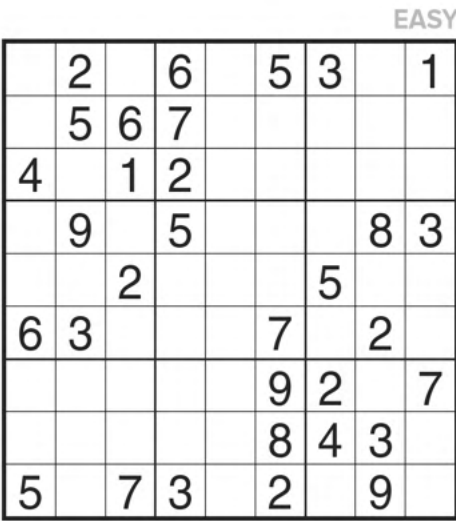


13 = E, 14 = Q, 15 = F, 17 = K, 18 = D, 19 = R, 20 = W, 22 = A, 23 = I, 24 = S
13 = E, 14 = Q, 15 = F, 17 = K, 18 = D, 19 = R, 20 = W, 22 = A, 23 = I, 24 = S

SUDOKU

No. 168

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

1. Which was named first, periwinkle the colour or periwinkle the plant?
2. In what country is Tsangpo Canyon, considered by many to be the world's deepest canyon?
3. Bruno Mars (pictured) and Anderson .Paak make up which R&B super duo?
4. And what is the title of their debut album, released in November 2021?
5. Who is Leader of the Opposition in the Senate?
6. Carnaby's black, salmon-crested and Major Mitchell's are types of what?
7. Obsidian Entertainment developed which 2019 action role-playing game?
8. What is the official language of Venezuela?
9. Confessions of an Ugly Stepsister, Mirror, Mirror and Son of a Witch are novels by which US author?
10. How are you cooking if you are sautéing?



ANSWERS: 1. The plant 2. Tibet 3. Silk Sonic 4. An Evening with Silk Sonic 5. Michaela Cash 6. Cockatoo 7. The Outer Worlds 8. Spanish 9. Gregory Maguire 10. Over high heat with little fat

WORDFIT

No. 078

3 LETTERS

- ALL
ARE
AVO
IMP
INN
INS
IRE
ITS
NAP
NEE
ORE
OWL
PEA
PEN
PIE
PIS
PRO
RED
RUN
SAC
TEE
UGH
UPS
WEE

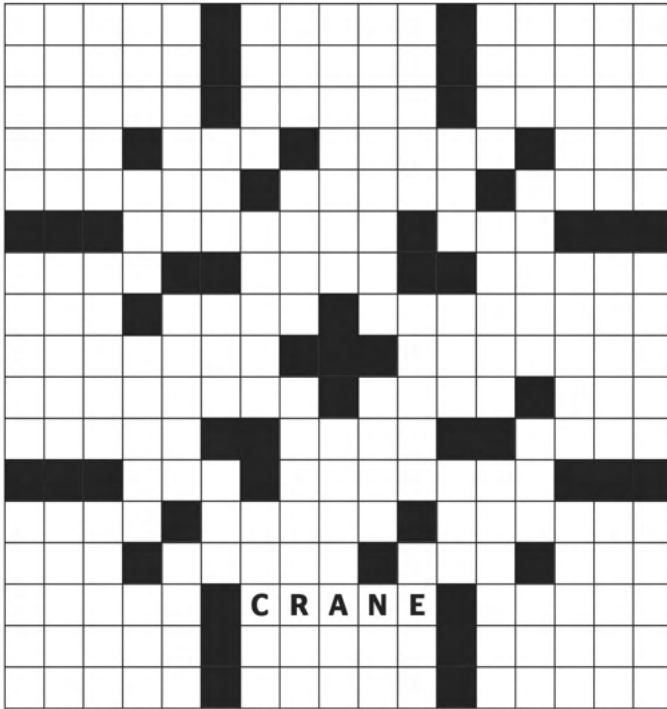
- SWAP
TENT
USED
WAYS
WRAP

5 LETTERS

- ABORT
ALLOT
AMISS
APART
ARENA
ASIDE
AVAIL
BACKS
CASTE
COLIC
CRANE
DRAWN
DRIPS
EDGED
EERIE
ENTRY
ERASE
FAUNA
FETID
GAMUT
GEARS
GENIE
GLARE
HANDY
HASTE
HEDGE
KORAN
LURED
MARIA

4 LETTERS

- CAMP
EARL
GEED
KISS
KNIT
OWNS
PAST
RAGS
SAGS



- MEATS
PLEAS
PRISM
RAFTS
SCARF
SEWER
SHARP
SIREN
SLEET
STAIR
STEER
STEPS
SWEPT
TAMES

- TEENS
TIRES
USING
WAFTS
WHENS
WHIRR
YOU'RE

- 7 LETTERS
FLASHER
LEAFIER
MAIMING
MONGREL
RINSING
WARFARE

- 8 LETTERS
APPEARED
INTEREST
TOMORROW
TORTILLA

6 LETTERS

- NEEDLE
PSEUDO
REHASH
RESIDE

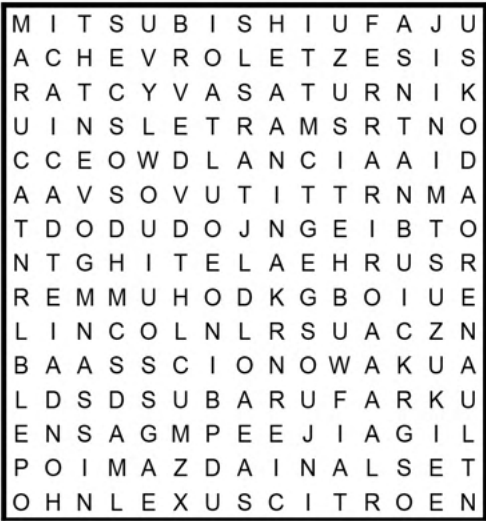
SOLUTION



WORD SEARCH

No. 078

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ACURA JAGUAR SAAB
AUDI JEEP SATURN
BENTLEY KIA SCION
BUICK LAMBORGHINI SEAT
CHEVROLET LANCIA SKODA
CITROEN LEXUS SMART
DACIA LINCOLN SUBARU
DODGE LOTUS SUZUKI
FERRARI MAZDA TESLA
FIAT MINI VOLKSWAGEN
FORD MITSUBISHI VOLVO
HONDA NISSAN
HUMMER OPEL
ISUZU RENAULT

SECRET MESSAGE: Just can't wait to get on the road again

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Wellington & District
LEADER





AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

For More Information call



Mb: 0428 635 994

ANOTHER WEEK of mostly hot dry conditions. The good news is this week will be much cooler with a chance of some rainfall on Monday 23rd

Following drought conditions, areas that receive fresh rain can trigger a flush of lush, rapidly growing pasture, particularly legumes. While the green feed looks ideal, it can dramatically increase the risk of rumen bloat in sheep and cattle.

Bloat occurs when gas produced during rumen fermentation becomes trapped in a stable foam, preventing the animal from releasing it naturally. The result can be rapid swelling of the rumen and, if not managed early animal losses will occur. Prevention is always the best strategy. APVMA approved supplement block “bloat-lick” is designed to help control bloat by acting as an anti-foaming agent in the rumen, helping livestock release asses.

This week AGSAFE is set to launch the first Product Stewardship Week (March 16 to 22) a national digital only initiative dedicated to highlighting the important role stewardship plays across Australian agriculture.

Throughout the week, they will be sharing stories and examples that demonstrate how industry is working together to support responsible product management from innovation and safe use through to recovery and recycling. Product stewardship week is designed to bring greater visibility to the practical work already happening across the sector and to recognise the organisations helping drive meaningful environmental and industry outcomes.

Because of the war in the Middle East when purchasing your fertiliser especially MAP you may notice differing product colour being lighter, because of new sourcing, this fertiliser meets the same standard.

Markets at a glance

WOOL 10th. EMI lost 48c closing 1517c/kg cln. Sydney. All MPGs down 17 to 69c, further falls on day2 especially the finer end. Merino skirtings firm for lots carrying low vm, (<5%) anything higher softened. XB softer day1 slipping 20 to 30c day2. NRI 1554c/kg (-53c) Sydney pass in rate 15.8% with 654 bales withdrawn. Mer cardings indicator up 6c to 829n c/kg clean.

CATTLE. CTLX. 2520, -1517. Young trade cattle lifted 20c and more in places. Yearling steers 440c to 513c, heifers 380c to 487c/kg. Feeder steers 15c dearer, 450c to 538c, heifers slipped 3c to 487c/kg. Light steers to restockers to 551c, heifers to 445c/kg. Grown cattle gained 20, heavy steers 386c to 478c, heifers 390c to 488c/kg. Cows firm, 2 and 3 scores 298c to 390c. Heavy cows 376c to 412c/kg, bulls to 424c/kg.

SHEEP. CTLX 11th. 2358 sheep (+283,) lambs 6147 (+1602). Light lambs sought after by restockers, little going to processors. Trade lambs 20kg to 24kg firm to dearer, \$248 to \$298. Heavy lambs steady, 24 to 26kg \$275 to \$316, up to 30kg \$315to \$347. Carcase price ave 1180c and 1240c/kg cwt. Lambs to restockers to \$266, heavy hoggets to \$280.

MUTTON. Mixed quality, prices remaining strong. Merno ewes \$148 to \$237, XB ewes \$152 to \$306. Merino wethers \$120 to \$188, heavy Dorper rams to \$210. Most ranged 840c to 880c/kg cwt.

SHOP STOCK CLEARANCE: as the shed is sold all stock must go. Fertilisers, seed, ag chem, drench, dips, poly pipe, small packs and shelving, large Avery scales as new, lots of antiques



Plasto & Company Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 7690. Large numbers of cows and their weaner alves. Well-finished grown heifers, some good runs of young cattle to suit feeders. Not all regular buyers present. Young trade cattle around firm, yearlings 410c to 498c/kg. Feeder steers 6c to 10c dearer, heifers 15c to 20c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 440c to 528c, heifers 390c to 460c/kg. Young restocker cattle up to 25c cheaper, steers to 594c/kg, heifers to 467c/kg. Grown heifers 10c dearer, 420c to 480c/kg. Cows 4c to 9c dearer, 2 and 3 scores to processors 312c to 395c/kg. Heavy cows 383c to 419c, ave 400c/kg. Cows to restockers 270c to 372c/kg. Heavy bulls 10c dearer to 430c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB.. 23,220. Numbers eased, quality better with more heavy lambs. Plenty of light lambs for restockers, good numbers of trade weights. Heavy lambs better supplied but longer skinned dry lambs were discounted. The market sold firm to slightly dearer. Restocking lambs \$157 to \$213. Trade \$226 to \$284, most 1060c and 1120c/kg. Merino trades \$210 to \$264, ave 1000c/kg. Heavy lambs \$255 to \$346, 1070c to 1110c/kg. Extra heavy \$328 to \$367, ave 1080c/kg cwt. Best heavy hoggets to \$289.

MUTTON.. Numbers also eased, quality mixed. Prices \$10 to \$15 cheaper overall. Medium ewes \$134 to \$218, heavy crossbred ewes to \$268, very heavy Merinos \$288. Most ranged 730c to 780c/kg cwt, only a few selected sales over 800c/kg cwt.

CTLX STORE CATTLE.. Just under 4000. Recent rain around district, quality good, demand to restock strong.

Mainly Angus and Angus X weaners 220kg to 280kg, some yearlings, very limited cow/calf units.. Weaner steers up \$60, heifers \$80 to \$100 better. Light weaner steers under 200kg \$920 to \$1100, medium 200kg to 330kg \$1000 to \$1775 reaching 611c/kg. Heavy steers over 330kg \$1650 to \$1895, most 540c and 560c/kg. Yearling steers to feed \$1705 to \$1990, ave520c/kg. Weaner heifers ave 440c to 460c/kg, lightweights \$460 to \$970, to 561c/kg. Medium \$800 to \$1460, heavy \$1475 to \$1600. yearlings and feeder heifers \$1230 to \$1600. Limited cow/calf run \$1475 to \$2300, Angus 3 in 1 unit \$2625.

WOOL.. Overall, another largely positive week. Northern region start doesn’t tell full story with both the Southern and Western regions failing to follow. The Northern market opened and rapidly continued to gain ground. By the end of the day the Merino fleece micron indicators were 50 to 70 cents dearer. The Western region selling after the North had closed, could only manage around one third of those gains. This led to a more subdued market on Wednesday with around 20 cents of Tuesdays gains lost. The Southern region continued sales on Thursday with the EMI down 3 cents. This was the first downward movement in the indicator since late January. 42,216 bales sold, passed in rate climbing to 7.2%. Major buyers Techwool, PJ Morris and Sequoia, purchasing over 50% of the national Merino fleece. Last week closing level the highest since June 2019 in both local currency and US dollars. 43,000 bales this week before dropping below 40,000 bales week.week.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending March 13, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week S37/25	This Week M37/25	Last Sale S36/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2418	2407	2375	+43	1735	+683
18	2373	2336	2318	+55	1650	+723
19	2250	2231	2217	+33	1552	+698
20	2136n	2102	2105n	+31	1508n	+628
21	-	2088n	-	-	1449n	-
26	898	879	888n	+10	615n	+283
28	688n	672	702n	-14	430n	+258
MC	1029n	1046n	1004n	+25	739n	+290

Just taking a breather

LAST WEEK’S wool market played out recording a solid rise, but ended the EMI’s upward run at 12 successive days. Selling was over three days, with Sydney and Fremantle offering on Tuesday, as Melbourne had a public holiday, all centres in operation Wednesday, and then the South selling in isolation on Thursday. The Northern opening was particularly strong, with Merino indicators lifting 50-80 cents, whilst in the West the gains were a more moderate 10-26 cents. Wednesday was a juggling act between the three centres, with Melbourne trying to catch up from the previous day’s levels, Sydney softening and Fremantle giving back more than the gains of Tuesday. Melbourne’s final selling day tended cheaper with only small downward movements. Skirtings continue to be well supported, as did cardings, but the crossbreds run has now halted for the time being. When reflecting on the wash up of last week, when viewed in US dollar terms, every week has been dearer than the previous week since the first sale of the year. This sentiment continues to be expressed by exporters in their dealings with top makers, telling us that the pipeline is still far from full. China is driving the market, but over recent weeks orders coming out of India have been filled out of the auction rooms, as well as European types at the finer end. The slight correction that was evident in the later parts of sales last week shouldn’t have any negativity associated with it, it is a combination of larger volumes on offer just taking the pressure off top makers supply situation, and the need from them to just temper the price momentarily, see where it levels out at, and then go again. When you look at the amount of wool that has come out of hold, which in the North has been up to 8% of the offering over a year old, and the added in with current testing data, and year on year data showing almost 53,000 bales less than this time last year, it’s not hard to see why mills that have invested millions of dollars on wool specific machinery now have a strong purchasing plan that we are witnessing week to week. In this week’s offering of 43,000 bales in the three selling centres Macwool and Carmichael Wool catalogued over 1400 bales on Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS







Fun time at the Boot - and it’s free

Join the fun and become a challenger in the Guys and Dolls Challenge during the 2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival weekend.

All you have to do is – turn up!

Attend the Boot Calcutta night at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club from 6pm in the auditorium, and if your name is drawn, you can draw a horse in the Wellington Boot race on Sunday, gain free entry to the race-course, enjoy a free lavish lunch and drinks throughout the day in the Wellington Race Club sponsors tent - all courtesy of Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, *Wellington & District Leader*, Eliza Whiteley Optometry and Wellington Race Club.

The 2026 Wellington Boot racing Carnival runs with an eight-race program on Friday, April 10 with \$10 admission on Friday.

The Boot Classic Golf Day at Wellington Golf Club runs on Saturday, then the Boot Calcutta on Saturday night with guest host Miracle Mal Johnson, the legend of racing.

Sunday is Boot day, the richest race over the great divide (bar Scone).

Gates open 11am and \$20 admission Sunday for everyone else without tickets.

Guys and Dolls Challenge

Fill-in an entry form at Wellington Soldiers memorial Club or club website. You must be aged 18 to 30 years.

Attend the Wellington Boot Calcutta on Saturday night April 10.

Gain free entry to Sunday’s Boot race meeting, enjoy lunch and drinks all day at the Wellington Race Club sponsor’s tent.

Each Challenger will receive a 2026 Wellington Boot Sash to keep and wear forever.

How it works

There are 14 runners in the 2026 Wellington Boot race.

On Saturday night at Calcutta, entry forms will be drawn from a barrel and the person nominated must be at the Calcutta.

That person then draws a horse in the Boot race.

UP to 14 people will drawn. If there are horse scratchings, then only Guys and Dolls with remaining horses are eligible to win the First, Second or Third prizes available, which will be presented to the drawers of those placed horses.

Dress-up for the day, and may like to also enter ‘Fashions on the Field’ competition.

It’s that simple. Get to it and enter now – it’s FREE.



YEOVAL CENTRAL SCHOOL (YCS)

TERM 1 NEWS



**OUR 2026
SCHOOL LEADERS:**
School Captains
House Captains
Student Representative
Council (SRC)



Thank you to
**Woolworths
Wellington** for
donating a
weekly fruit
basket to YCS
students.



Years 7/8 attended
an overnight
excursion at
**Wambangalang
Environmental
Education Centre.**



We welcomed special guests to our
annual YCS Family BBQ Get-Together.



YCS has partnered with
the **Mid Macquarie
Landcare Group** to run
the Nature Spotters
Program.



Our very supportive **P&C** pictured
at the annual YCS Swimming
Carnival.

Principal: Ms Trish Henderson
P: 6846 4004 **E:** yeoval-c-school@det.nsw.edu.au
www.yeoval-c.schools.nsw.gov.au



Wellington Public School

Inclusive Education



Inclusive Education students engage in sport with Stage 1!

Students from our Inclusive Education classes Aqua and Gold have been joining in sport with the year 1 and 2 classes each week.

The students from these classes benefit from socialising with their peers in mainstream and learn new skills each week supported by our Teachers and Aides in all activities.

This is often the highlight of their week and it promotes acceptance and resilience, boosts the students self esteem and most of all it is fun!



Gold class have been learning about the book, "Where is the green sheep!" They have been having a lot of fun finding the sheep in their classroom!



Golfing News Centenary afternoon at golf club

...From Back Page.

Prize winners were Anthony Mckeown from Gulgong, Joe Ryan, Lewis Stanley from Walgett 35pts. Results from last week' Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole competition was Adam Ryan on a c/b 33nett. Runner-up, Paul West also with 33nett.

Leaderboard with one round left to play has Joe Ryan leading with-16, Adam Ryan -15, Gary McCarroll-13, Tim Parker -12, David Ryan-11. Back 9holes to played on 19th with presentation night on Friday, 27th from 6pm with a Putting Competition to be held prior to the Presentation.

J and B Cup Finals, Matchplay Championships, A grade, Kurt Cusack v David O'Brien, Mitchell Cusack v ?, David East v John Gersbach, John Donnelly v Mathew Redfern, Elton Keeffe v Gary Cusack.

B grade, David Hyde v Daniel McCullum, Rod McMahon v Wayne Lang, Steven McCarroll v Tim Parker, Noel Stanford v Stephen Whiteman.

C grade, Rod Irwin v bye, Warren Williams v John Southwell, Drew Stone v bye, Cody Conn v Ron Cowan.

Round 1 matches are to be played by March 21.

Kiss Trophy results from round 1 saw B Kiss v Bye, W Bruce defeated R Cowan, R Baker defeated Rod McMahon, David O'Brien defeated Brock Naden, P Neuenhaus defeated D Stone, P West defeated D East, D Bell defeated Pat Slack-Smith, Norm Royal defeated Rod Irwin, B Eather defeated v Wayne Lang, Kurt Cusack v Bye, J Bar-

ton defeated M Cornish, C Royal defeated M Ringland, Rod Miller defeated Rod Pedron, John Gersbach defeated Nathan Stewart, N Stanford defeated G Hollow, D Naveau defeated M Payne, J Bullock v D Hyde to be finalised, K Reid v Bye, D Ney v Daniel McCullum to be finalised, Tim Parker defeated R Parnell, A Ryan defeated P Holden, S Whiteman defeated Conn, Elton Keeffe defeated D Haesler, J Ryan v Bye, D Wilson defeated J Donnelly, W Slack-Smith defeated A Brien, A Bullock defeated J Fleming, R Agar defeated J Armstrong, G McNaughton defeated L Conn, Gary Cusack defeated M Britton, J Southwell defeated D Ryan, S Kiss v Bye.

Round 2 matches in the Kiss Trophy sees B Kiss v W Bruce, R Baker v D O'Brien, P Neuenhaus v P West, D Bell v N Royal, B Eather v K Cusack, J Barton v C Royal, R Miller v J Gersbach, N Stanford v D Naveau, K Reid v Bullock or Hyde, T Parker v Ney or McCullum, A Ryan v S Whiteman, E Keeffe v J Ryan, D Wilson v W Slack-Smith, A Bullock v R Agar, G McNaughton v G Cusack, J Southwell v S Kiss.

Round 2 matches are to be played by April 4.

This Saturday's events are an Individual Stroke event plus round 1 of the J and B Matchplay Championships.

This Sunday the Bulabul Battery AMPYR Ladies Wellington Open will be played.

Next Saturday and Sunday will be the Cusack's Butchery Men's Foursomes Championships.

19th Hole



Charlie, Max, Jeremy and Ben in their carts.



Kevin Reid, Dave Wilson, Rodney Cunynghame and Brent Eather.

Young Aggies tour Wellington's Glenalbyn Santa Gertrudis enterprise

BRINGING YOUNG people together to share ideas, insights, and perspectives from across the industry was a purpose of the Central West Young Aggies field day at Glenalbyn Santa Gertrudis Stud on Twelve Mile Road, Wellington recently.

The day began with an introductory session from CWYA president, Bec Short and a brief insight into the program run at Glenalbyn from the stud's principal Jack Courts, a third-generation principal who gave an exclusive, behind-the-scenes visit to his family operation built over more than half a century.

Originally established in Bourke, and relocated to Wellington in 2014, Glenalbyn has carried forward a proud legacy grounded in integrity, consistency, and continual improvement.

Since becoming principal in 2023, Jack has continued to refine the stud with a strong emphasis on fertility, growth, and carcass quality, producing adaptable Santa Gertrudis cattle that are sound, productive, and profitable for modern beef producers, guided by client feedback and long-term performance.

A 2024 Nuffield Scholar, Jack has explored maternal efficiency in ruminant animals, examining genetics, reproduction, and feed efficiency to strengthen productivity and support the industry's sustainability goals.

With experience across the beef and sheep industries, including time in the northern beef industry, studies at Marcus Oldham, and most recently as farm manager at Mumblebone Merino Stud, nearby, Jack brings a practical perspective to the next chapter of Glenalbyn, ensuring the



At the field day are Shannon Bow, CWYA treasurer, Tim Flynn, Jack Courts and Mark Mudford.

stud continues to evolve for generations to come.

Ther day's first panel discussion had a focus on economics and finance in the world of agriculture with speakers, Dr Cheryl Gordon (economist), John Howard (CEO of RIC), and Simon Provost (RAA).

A second panel highlighted real estate and law proceedings as well as on-farm knowledge with Jack Courts, Tim Flynn (Founder of Land Law Co & Producer), Mark Mudford (LAWD, Producer, and Dubbo Chamber of Commerce president).

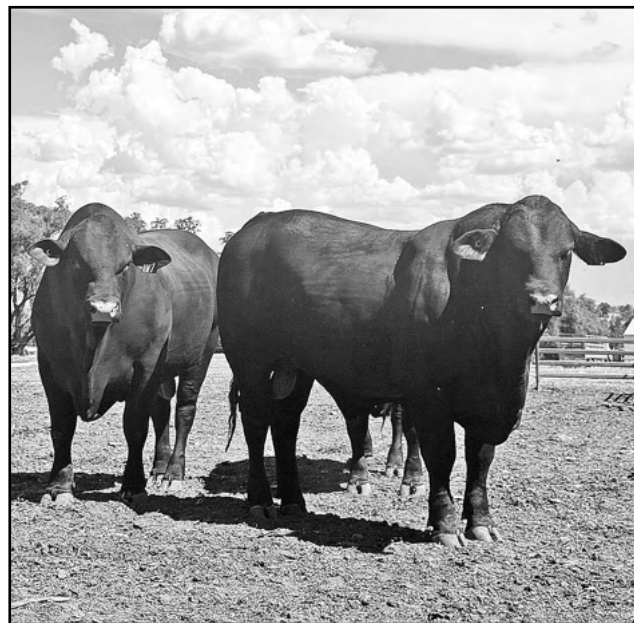
"Gadgets in the Grass" had INCYT share their knowledge in the world ag-technology and engineering to make farming enterprises run smoothly.

Throughout the day walkthroughs were provided of the

sale complex and livestock yards with a discussion around the commercial trading and stud production Glenalbyn runs.

Networking sessions came naturally with like-minded individuals making connections and sharing thoughts in the space of agriculture.

Clair Stiff



Glenalbyn Santa Gertrudis bulls on display.

Nearly fully restored

THE OLD Jack & Jill garden seat was brought to the Wellington Men's Shed a bit worse for wear and weathered.

It had good bones as they say and was worth restoring.

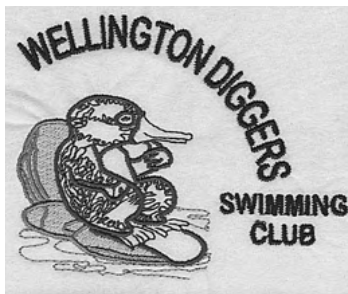
Ken was able to replace the timbers that were damaged with wood that matched from our stock pile of salvaged timber.

A good sanding was done and now it will go to spray paint booth to get a new glossy paint finish, then be returned to its owner and the verandah in all its glory.



Your sport can record results in the "Sport" section. Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News



TEN MEMBERS participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, March 10.

Wayne Rich won the 30-metre event being 0.29 outside his time while Katharine O'Rourke was second with Di Donnelly third.

Katharine O'Rourkec went on to win the 50-metre swim being 0.09 outside her time.

Janelle Frappell was second with Terry Dray third.

Mason Hill won both junior events while Katharine



O'Rourke and Rhylee Hill won the Brace being 1.53 outside their time

Next week, Tuesday, March 24 will be our last swim for the season.

Presentation night or day is yet to be arranged.

Results for Tuesday, March 10.

Juniors

30 Metres: 1 Mason Hill 1.35+, 2 Rhylee Hill 2.22-, 3 Tilly Hill 3.47.

50 Metres: 1 Mason Hill 0.97+,

2 Rhylee Hill 2.12-, 3 Tilly Hill 7.53+.

Seniors

30 Metres: 1 Wayne Rich 0.29-, 2 Katharine O'Rourke 0.37-, 3 Di Donnelly 0.90+.

50 Metres: 1 Katharine O'Rourke 0.09, 2 Janelle Frappell 0.12-, 3 Terry Dray 2.56+.

Brace Relay: 1 Katharine O'Rourke & Rhylee Hill 1.53-, 2 Mason Hill & Nick Knowles 2.78.

The Platypus

Swim Pointscore

- Carmen Gain photos

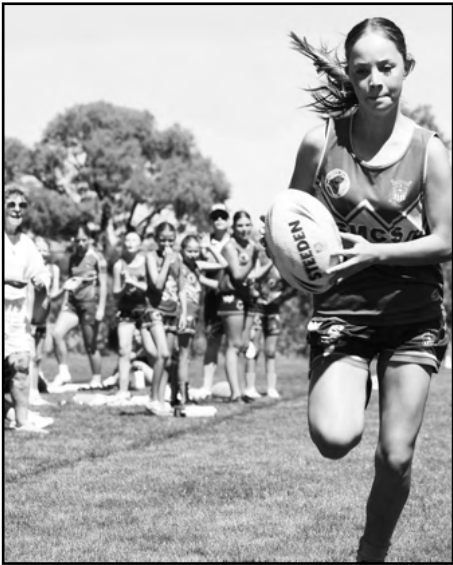


St Mary's Touch Champs - Jo Ivey Photos

St Mary's girls score hat-trick at Regional Touch

SAINT MARY'S Wolf Pack contested the NSW Touch Football Regional Western Carnival at Orange last Wednesday with a girls and boys 7-8 teams. Both teams had a great day on the field with both making finals. St Mary's girls team finished the day undefeated beating Oberon, All Saints, Canobolas, Orange High and Cowra. The girls then took on James Sheahan in the final. With nothing separating both teams the game was getting physical and into a tough grind. The game was locked at 2-2 until a late try to the Pack

and some excellent defence to hold on and finish on top. The girls were victorious and for a third straight year our girls are regional champions and will again contest State in term 3. St Mary's young boys team played well above their weight playing an excellent running game and getting bog wins over much bigger schools Oberon, Cowra and Canobolas making it into the semi-finals but going down to James Sheahan 4-2. The teams are so lucky to have such great supporters.



Golfing News

Ryan's foursome takes out centenary trophy

WELLINGTON GOLF course was buzzing with the celebrations of the club's 100th anniversary last Sunday attracting a big turnout of club members, past presidents and captains and many friends of the club on hand to wish the club all the best for another 100 years.

The celebration cake was presented by Barry Jeffery, representing the Soldiers Memorial Club, and cut by Kathy Martin and John Gersbach representing the Ladies and Men golfers.

There were plenty of old photos of past golfers who are sadly not with us anymore, plus the many Trophies on show as well.

A Four-person Ambrose was played with 64 golfers hitting the fairways on a glorious day and every team played well under there handicaps.

Winners of the day was the team captained by Joe Ryan who finished with a score of 53nett.

Runners-up were the team led by Peter Holden finishing with 54.7nett.

A Bradman trophy was awarded to the usual suspects for this prize, their skip was Rodney Cunynghame, and they finished with a respectful score of 63.7nett.

Nearest the pin for ladies on the third was Kathy Martin while Brent Eather gained the mens' pin on the 8th.

Longest drive award went to Joe Ryan.

A special thank you to Sam Coon who entertained the crowd with some very fine music.

Big thank you to Barry Jeffery who cooked the barbeque and spent the day at the Golf Club organising and presenting prizes.

Also a big thank you to all who organised the day as it

went off without a hitch - you all should be proud of your great work.

Last Saturday's events were an Individual Stableford plus Round 1 of the Kiss Trophy.

Winner of A grade was Wayne Lang who had a big day out on the course with his final score being 40pts, but he did somehow manage to lose his Kiss Match.

Runner up was Gareth Petersen who also had a good day to finish with 38pts.

Winner in B grade was Cody Conn who jumped out of his boots to finish the day with 40pts. Runner-up was Brent (Billy) Eather who had the golfing day of his life to finish with 39pts.

Prize winners were, David O'Brien, Mitchell Cusack, Joe Ryan, Bryan Kiss 36pts; Noel Stanford, Garry McNaughton, Brock Naden, Cheryl Royal, David Naveau 35pts; Stephen Whiteman, Norm Royal, Tim Parker, Gary Cusack, Elton Keeffe 34pts.

Nearest the pins on 3rd Garry McNaughton, 8th Ryan McCracken, 14th Rob Parnell, 16th Tim Parker.

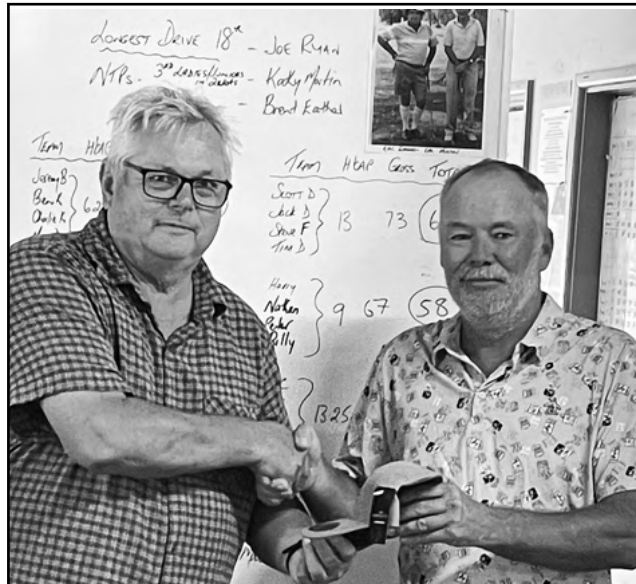
Nearest the pin in two shots on 13th was Rob Parnell.

Longest drives went to Wayne Lang in A grade and Brock Naden in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was again hotly contested with a few golfers trying their worst to claim the prize, but it went to Adam Ryan who managed a hard-fought 23pts.

Wednesday's Ladies played an Individual Stableford plus the 9-hole competition.

Winner was Jan Payne who played extremely well to clean the field up with 39pts. Runner-up was Kathy



Soldiers Golf Club director Barry Jeffery presents winner's trophy to Joe Ryan whose team won the golf club centenary Four-person Ambrose

Martin who compiled a nice score of 37pts. Prize winner Cathy Loo-Shui 35pts.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was James Fleming and all smiles after finishing with 39pts. Runner-up was Nathan Stewart with 35pts on a countback.

... Continued on Page 17.
See Page 4 for more centenary game photos.

TOOHEYS

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NIGEL STANLEY

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STARTS FROM 7.30PM

MEGA

\$2,000 WORTH OF EASTER EGGS TO RAFFLE

EASTER EGG

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SUNDAY 29 MARCH